



Complaints Policy

Complaints Policy					
ID & Version	PO5-V1	Last Review	Aug 2025	Next Review	Aug 2028
Purpose					
To outline how complaints from staff, faculty, students, and external stakeholders can be raised and fairly, respectfully, and promptly resolved.					
Scope					
This policy applies to: • Staff – employees of the organisation • Faculty – contracted trainers, and academic contributors • Students – individuals participating on any course • External stakeholders – clients or members of the public interacting with our services Note: Personal employment concerns (e.g. bullying, working conditions) must be addressed through the Grievance Policy. Academic assessment appeals are covered by the Student Appeals Policy.					
Policy Statement					
Pulse 8 is committed to providing a high-quality service to everyone that engages with our organisation and welcome the views of our service from staff, faculty students and other stakeholders. We understand and accept that issues may arise during their engagement with us. To meet this commitment, should any issue arise and be brought to our attention, we will: • Listen and make every effort to come to a satisfactory resolution • Take all complaints seriously • Ensure that all complaints are dealt with in fair, consistent, and transparent manner • Respond in a timely manner • Accept and investigate any complaint that is found to have merit, irrespective of the nature of the complaint or who the person making the complaint is • Treat all parties to any complaint with courtesy, respect, and empathy • Endeavour to find a satisfactory solution in all cases					
For additional information contact admin@pulse8.ie					

Supporting Information

1. What is a complaint?

A complaint is when you are unhappy with something that happened and want the organisation to look into it. This might include:

- Being treated unfairly
- Poor communication or lack of information
- Rude or unprofessional behaviour
- Something promised that wasn't delivered
- A risk to safety or quality
- A policy or procedure not being followed properly

We encourage people to speak up as soon as possible so we can address the issue quickly.

2. Our Commitment

We will:

- Treat you with respect and listen carefully.
- Deal with the complaint as quickly and fairly as possible.
- Protect your privacy.
- keep a record of the complaint and any action taken.
- Use complaints to improve our services.

3. Confidentiality

All complaints will be handled confidentially. Only those directly involved in resolving the issue will be given access to complaint details.

2. Quality Improvement

Complaints will be tracked and reviewed annually as part of internal QA to identify patterns and support continuous improvement.

Complaints Management
Activities
1. Informal Resolution (Encouraged Where Appropriate)
- If appropriate, raise the issue directly with the person involved (e.g. a colleague, instructor, contact person). - This may be done through a short conversation or written message. - If the concern is about the MD, it may be raised confidentially with the CQA, who will refer it to a Pulse 8 approved third party. - If the issue is not resolved, or the complainant prefers, proceed to a formal complaint
2. Submit a Formal Complaint
- Submit the complaint in writing to the MD, or to the CQA if the MD is the subject of the complaint. Include the following: - Your full name and role (or organisation if external) - A description of the issue, including relevant dates and people involved - Any supporting evidence (e.g. emails, screenshots) - Steps already taken (if any) - What outcome you are seeking - The complaint will be acknowledged within 5 working days. Note: The CQA will pass complaints about the MD to a Pulse 8 approved third party.
3. Review and Investigation
- The complaint will be reviewed by the MD, or by a Pulse 8 approved third party if the MD is the subject of the complaint. - Meetings may be held with the complainant and others involved. - A support person may attend if requested. - The investigation should be completed within 10–15 working days, depending on complexity.
4. Outcome
- A written decision will be issued within 5 working days of the investigation being completed. The decision will include: - A summary of findings - Any actions taken - Whether the complaint is upheld, partially upheld, or not upheld - If more time is required, the complainant will be notified with reasons.
5. Appeal
- Appeals must be submitted in writing within 5 working days of receiving the outcome. - If the original decision was made by the MD, the appeal will be reviewed by a Pulse 8 approved third party. - The appeal will be reviewed by someone who was not involved in the original decision. - A final written decision will be issued within 10 working days.